

Guide 1 of 5

10 Fall Prevention Tips Every Family Should Know

From the clinical team at Savoy Therapy

Falls are the leading cause of injury-related death in adults over 65 — and most are preventable. This guide gives you 10 practical, clinically proven strategies to reduce fall risk starting today.

THE 10 TIPS

1. Do strength and balance exercises regularly

Even 20 minutes of targeted exercise three times a week measurably improves stability and reaction time. Ask a physical therapist for a program designed for your loved one's specific abilities.

2. Review medications with a physician

Many medications cause dizziness, low blood pressure, or reduced alertness. If your loved one takes four or more medications, ask their doctor specifically about fall risk.

3. Get a vision check every year

Poor vision is one of the top contributors to falls. Even small changes in vision can affect depth perception and the ability to see edges and steps clearly.

4. Wear proper footwear — always

No bare feet, no socks on hard floors, no backless slippers. Shoes should have a firm heel, non-slip sole, and fasten securely around the foot.

5. Light up every path

Install nightlights along the route from bedroom to bathroom. Motion-activated lights are even better. Most nighttime falls happen on this path.

6. Clear the walking paths

Remove loose rugs, electrical cords, and any clutter from hallways, bedrooms, and living areas. These are the most common trip hazards in the home.

7. Install grab bars — not towel bars

Grab bars in the shower, beside the toilet, and at any step entry point provide secure support. Towel bars are not weight-bearing and should never be used as grab bars.

8. Rise slowly from sitting or lying down

Dizziness upon standing (orthostatic hypotension) is a common fall trigger. Teach your loved one to sit at the edge of the bed or chair for 30 seconds before standing.

9. Stay hydrated

Dehydration causes dizziness and confusion. Many older adults don't feel thirst reliably. Aim for 6-8 glasses of water daily unless a physician has advised otherwise.

10. Ask for a fall prevention screening

Savoy Therapy offers complimentary fall prevention screenings for all residents in our partner communities. A trained therapist can identify specific risks and recommend targeted interventions.

A NOTE FROM SAVOY THERAPY

If your loved one has already had a fall, the most important thing you can do is not wait for the next one. Physical therapy after a fall can restore confidence, rebuild strength, and dramatically reduce future risk. Reach out to us — no referral needed.

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